Folio: Strategic Report

1. Executive summary

Folio is a mobile-friendly learning application for **first-year accounting students**. It brings course materials, practice questions, and guided support into one place that students can use outside class hours.

Students will practise core skills, especially journal entries and other foundational tasks, and receive **clear, specific feedback** when something is wrong: which account, whether debit or credit, and whether the amount is correct. Over time, Folio will also offer an AI learning assistant that **hints and explains using lecturer-approved materials**, rather than inventing answers or replacing the lecturer.

Lecturers stay in control. They upload and publish content, build the question bank, and see where the cohort is struggling. The AI supports teaching; it does not become the official grader for assessment unless the institution later decides otherwise.

The name **Folio** comes from accounting practice: a *folio* is the page or reference that links a journal entry to the ledger. That image fits the aim of helping students connect what they tried with where it belongs in the books.

We propose to start with a **pilot in one first-year accounting course**, prove that students and lecturers find it useful, then expand carefully to further courses.

2. Strategic context

2.1 Why this project matters

Pressure	How Folio responds
Students need more practice and explanation than contact hours allow	Practice available when needed, with precise feedback and later guided help
First-year accounting depends heavily on fundamentals (journals, debits/credits)	Interactive exercises aimed at those exact skills
AI in education raises trust and academic integrity concerns	Lecturer-owned content; explanations grounded in approved materials; clear separation of practice and assessment
Lecturers lack a simple view of where the class is stuck	Progress and topic-level insight for teaching staff
Support must work on phones and limited data	Designed first for small screens and everyday student devices

2.2 Strategic intent

1. **Extend academic support** beyond the timetable without hiring one tutor per student.
2. **Protect academic standards.** Lecturers own content, answer keys, and assessment judgement.
3. **Learn from a pilot** before rolling out widely.
4. **Build something reusable** for additional accounting modules once quality is proven.

3. Who it is for

Group	What they get

Students	Course materials, practice questions, immediate feedback, progress view, and later a helpful tutor that guides without simply giving the answer away
Lecturers	Tools to publish materials and questions, preview the student experience, and see which topics cause difficulty
Teaching assistants	Support with flagged work and discussions within courses they are assigned to
Administrators	Account and course administration, with no routine access to private student and tutor conversations

Initial curriculum focus: first-year accounting modules (ACC101 and ACC102), organised by course, topic, and learning outcome.

4. Forward-facing features

These are the capabilities stakeholders should expect Folio to offer as it matures. They are described in everyday language.

4.1 For students

- **One place to study.** Enrolled course materials, searchable by topic, usable on a phone.
- **Practice that feels like the subject.** Multiple choice, numerical answers, and **journal entries** (account, debit/credit, amount, including multi-line entries).
- **Feedback that names the mistake.** Not only "incorrect," but *which part* went wrong.
- **A second chance with a hint.** Try again after guidance, before seeing a full worked explanation.
- **A personal progress view.** What is going well, what to revisit, and suggested next practice.
- **A learning assistant** (after the practice pilot is solid). Hint-first help, tied to approved notes and model answers, with sources shown where possible.

4.2 For lecturers and teaching staff

- **Materials library.** Upload notes, slides, short video links, and summaries; publish when ready.
- **Question bank.** Create questions or import a reviewed list; set hints and common misconceptions.
- **Publish with confidence.** Content starts unpublished; staff preview before students see it.
- **Course insight.** Which topics students miss most, and patterns that can inform teaching.
- **Oversight of AI help.** Ability to preview assistant behaviour and review responses that need attention.

4.3 For the institution

- **Private learning records.** Students see their own progress; staff access follows agreed policy.
- **Safe use of AI.** Explanations based on approved course content, with an honest "we don't have enough in the materials" when that is true.
- **Practice and assessment kept distinct.** Clear modes so practice support is not confused with formal grading.
- **A path to grow.** Start with one course; expand to further accounting modules after evaluation.

4.4 Later enhancements (after a successful pilot)

These are valuable, but deliberately **not** the first promise:

- Smarter revision schedules based on what each student finds hard
- A small business simulation (record transactions through to statements)
- Short written "explain your reasoning" tasks

- Moderated peer discussion
- Accessibility extras (audio, captions, carefully reviewed language support)
- Optional photo upload of handwritten work (only when quality and fairness can be assured)

6.1 Core product deliverables (pilot)

Deliverable	Description
Folio learning application	A phone-friendly web app for first-year accounting practice and study
Student accounts and enrolment	Secure sign-in; students joined to the right course; ability to reset access and withdraw if needed
Materials library	Lecturers upload and publish course materials; students browse and open approved items
Question bank and practice	Lecturer-managed questions including journal entries; students attempt and receive detailed feedback on each part of an answer
Progress and insight views	Students see their own progress; lecturers see topic-level difficulty patterns
Staff administration	Tools for accounts, courses, and basic oversight consistent with institutional policy